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MONDAY, JUNE 15, 2026

New Medicaid work rules create headaches

Proving ‘frailty’ will likely be an ordeal for those who most need health benefit

By Jason Laughlin
and Marin Wolf

GLOBE STAFF

What does it mean to be medically frail?

Describing who would not be required to work in order to receive government subsidized health care under new rules, the Trump administration includes in its definition of medical frailty having cancer, a drug addiction, mental illness, and other

documented conditions that make it difficult for people to take care of themselves.

But what should be a straightforward exercise for applicants risks turning into an onerous ordeal that can strip health care from thousands of sick patients in the process, according to health care experts who have reviewed the new federal guidelines for Medicaid work requirements issued by the Centers for

Medicare & Medicaid Services in early June.

Not only will people have to receive a qualifying diagnosis, they’ll also have to prove their illness makes them so sick that they can’t work. And health care providers charged with evaluating individuals for exemptions say they haven’t received any guidance to determine who is too sick to work.

“You can’t build a house, pass an inspection, and then be told the blueprints were wrong all along,” said Dr. Rishi Wadhwa, a Harvard Medical School assistant professor

who has conducted studies identifying the populations most at risk of losing their coverage.

The national work requirement, included in President Trump’s One Big Beautiful Bill Act that Congress passed last year, mandates that most Medicaid recipients between the ages of 19 and 64 will have to prove they work, attend school, or volunteer. The rule largely applies to those who received Medicaid through the Affordable Care Act’s coverage expansion.

Some work exemptions, such as

MEDICAID, Page A6

US, Iran agree to cease-fire accord

Deal, set to be signed Friday, reopens key strait; major issues unresolved

By Farnaz Fassihi, Adam Rasgon,
and Ronen Bergman

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The United States and Iran declared Sunday they would cease hostilities for the next 60 days, the first major agreement between the two nations since the start of a war that has gripped the Middle East since late February. For now, however, they left unresolved the critical issue of whether and how Iran would agree to strict limits on its nuclear program.

Leaders of the two nations proclaimed that they had reached the agreement after an intensive flurry of last-minute negotiations complicated by an Israeli airstrike earlier in the day on a Hezbollah stronghold near Beirut.

The framework commits both governments to halting military operations on all fronts, including Lebanon, and immediately reopening the Strait of Hormuz, allowing the free flow of oil and other products from the Middle East into global markets, according to officials briefed on the pact.

Under the terms of the agreement, known as the “memorandum of understanding,” the United States is to begin dismantling its naval blockade of

IRAN, Page A7



PHOTOS BY LANE TURNER/GLOBE STAFF

Exterior themes are continued inside the mostly abandoned Government Services Center in the West End.

INSIDE A REVILED BEHEMOTH: SPLENDOR AND, MAYBE, HOMES?

Redemption could be at hand for Brutalist Government Services Center

By Murray Whyte

GLOBE STAFF

The Boston Government Services Center, a bleak behemoth of stippled gray concrete, was probably a mistake. A stony fortress with studded ramparts rising 40 feet above Staniford Street, it imposes its will on the streetscape for blocks around. Since it was finished in 1972, it’s been a deadening force on the West End, a black hole, a void.

To be fair, it wasn’t alone. Built in the middle of the last century in the era of urban renewal — a blithe term for a cataclysmic agenda that razed downtown neighborhoods nationwide for high-



“We have an opportunity here to heal what was torn apart,” said Bill Holt, a program manager for the state.

ways, public housing towers, and, yes, government megaprojects — its intentions were noble: a bold vision of the future amid a city on the brink of collapse. But few mistakes of such epic scale have a real chance at redemption. For the Government Services Center, it may be at hand.

Earlier this month, the state of Massachusetts, its owner, put out an official call to redevelop the complex into housing, retail, and leisure, a challenge for even the most vivid imagination. But done right, it would bring life back not only to a part of downtown that most hurry through, but to the complex itself. A big

CENTER, Page A10

US lawsuits raise Campbell profile

Legal landscape becomes entangled, but Democrats praise AG as tenacious

By Anjali Huynh

GLOBE STAFF

Democrats have long demanded that their party respond more forcefully to President Trump’s efforts to slash funding and reorder the federal government as America knows it.

But there’s one figure for whom Massachusetts activists have had few complaints — Andrea Campbell.

Massachusetts’ attorney general has sued the federal government more than 50 times since Trump took office last year, using millions of dollars in additional taxpayer funding to hire attorneys and form the state-level bulwark that, more often than not, beats the administration in court.

With that has come regular praise from fellow Democrats, including ground-level enthusiasm at the state Democratic convention last month, where attendees lined the hallway before Campbell’s speech to snap photos with her. Not unlike with Governor Maura Healey — who, as attorney general, forged a growing profile in battling Trump in court — supporters have already floated Campbell running for higher office.

“I had the thought, this is a future governor or

CAMPBELL, Page A7



It’s time to glow

Monday: Mostly sunny.
High 82-87, low 57-62.

Tuesday: Cooler, pleasant.
High 74-79, low 56-61.

High tide: 11:57 a.m.
Sunrise: 5:07. Sunset: 8:23.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **C9.**

VOL. 309, NO. 166

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



The World Cup arrived in Boston on Saturday with feverish fans, the beat of drums, the drone of bagpipes, and a handful of transportation issues. **B1.** Game coverage, **C1.**

The discovery of a racial slur in a dictionary at a Milton elementary school has generated concern among parents. **B1.**

A plane crashed near Kansas City, Mo., killing 11 skydivers and the pilot. **A2.**

As some investors back away from Boston’s real estate market, a prominent German firm is ready to jump in. **D1.**

The Carolina Hurricanes won its second Stanley Cup, stifling Las Vegas, 3-0. **C1.**

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In the doodlesphere and off their leashes

They’re invading parks, websites, media. No, not the dogs. The owners.

BETH TEITELL

Help! I’ve been sucked into a doodle bubble and I can’t get out. When I go to my social media to check for news, here’s what happens: wars, sports, peptides, Taylor Swift’s wedding snubs — all are choked out by doodle content.

I was (re)watching an Instagram video titled “Obsessive Doodle Disorder” the other day — chuckling with recognition as the camera zoomed in on a doodle’s snout, and a voiceover intoned, “advanced cases [of ODD] include 4,000 photos of the same dog [and] allowing the doodle to control daily schedules” — when an uncomfortable question hit me.

DOODLES, Page A10



ILANA ZAHAVY FOR THE GLOBE